

Business Case

Value Analysis

SkillUp is aimed at people who enjoy recreational activities but need a centralized platform where they can track their progress, accomplishments, and contributions in one place. People can sometimes have difficulty staying motivated or consistently participating in their hobbies because they are unable to easily quantify or visualize their progress.

With SkillUp, users can increase their engagement in recreational activities while having access to a platform where they can showcase their experiences, track their progress, connect with others, and continue learning. By providing these features in one centralized platform, SkillUp encourages users to remain active and motivated as they develop their skills and pursue their interests.

SkillUp also gives users the opportunity to connect with experienced instructors, take courses, and obtain certifications, all with the goal of expanding their knowledge and developing new skills. In addition to providing value to users, these features create potential monetary value for the platform through partnerships with instructors, organizations, sponsors, and other outside contributors. SkillUp can provide these partners with a platform to promote their products, courses, and services to users who are already interested in recreational activities and skill development.

Go/no-go Recommendation

Our team has decided to proceed with SkillUp after determining that the project has the potential to reach a broad audience. Because SkillUp is designed to provide a personalized experience, it can appeal to users with a variety of recreational interests. Additionally, our interviewees shared common struggles related to staying motivated and tracking their progress, indicating that the platform could address meaningful user's needs.

However, for the initial release, we decided to “Go” with a controlled initial scope by focusing on the core features of the platform. One of the main features is a personal portfolio where users can maintain a centralized archive of their recreational activities, accomplishments, and experiences while also tracking and visualizing their progress over time.

Estimation Appendix

Scope of Estimate

The estimate covers the User Portfolio Management and Analysis slice of SkillUp. This slice includes recording recreational activities, tracking progress for individual activities, viewing overall accomplishments, customizing the user's portfolio, and setting personalized goals. The selected stories total 31 story points.

Two primary estimation methods were used to evaluate the slice using different starting information. Analogous Estimation starts from the development effort of a similar real product, while Story Points start from the team's own backlog estimates and an assumed velocity. Using these methods, we received the following:

Method	Low	Most Likely	High	Main Basis
Analogous	144 hrs	180 hrs	216 hrs	Everyday.app comparison
Story Points	248 hrs	326 hrs	414 hrs	31 story points and assumed velocity
Bottom-Up Budget Estimate		305 hrs		Detailed work-package estimates

The two primary estimation methods produce an overall range of 144-414 team hours. The Bottom-Up method estimated 305 hours, which also falls within the range produced by the other two methods, and we chose it as the planning value for budgeting.

Analogous Estimation

For the analogous estimate, the team used Everyday.app as the comparable product since it had similar functionality to our slice. Everyday.app was developed by one developer and took approximately three weeks.

We estimated that the SkillUp slice represents between 100%-150% of Everyday.app's functionality. Both products allow to record actions and track your progress, but SkillUp extends functionality by offering tracking for recreational activities, customize your portfolio, and set personalized goals. The initial estimate of 120-180 hours was then increased by 20% for coordination due to having a 5-person team. Results:

Low: 144 hours Middle: 180 hours High: 216 hours

We have lower confidence in these estimates due to the slice-size comparison and the 20% coordination adjustment being assumptions.

Story Points Estimation

The Story Points method starts with the team's backlog. The selected slice had 31 story points, and the estimate assumes a team of 5 people, with 40 hours per person per sprint. Since the team does not have past sprint data, we estimated a velocity of 15 / 19/ 25 points per sprint for low, middle and high velocity scenarios. This gave us the following results:

Assumed Velocity	Sprints Required	Estimated Effort
25 points/sprint	1.24	248 hrs
19 points/sprint	1.63	326 hrs
15 points/sprint	2.07	414 hrs

The Story Points range is between 248-414 hours, with 326 as the middle estimate. Since we have not completed a sprint yet, velocity is our biggest uncertainty, but once the team completes actual sprints, we can replace our assumptions with accurate data.

The two primary methods produced different estimates due to relying on different assumptions. Analogous Estimation depended on similarity of Skill Up to Everyday.app, while Story Points depended on assumed sprint velocity.

Bottom-Up Planning Estimate

For this method we broke down the slice into specific work packages:

- User portfolio and Activity Tracking – 70 hrs
- Progress Tracking and Reporting – 90 hrs
- Portfolio Customization and Goals – 55 hrs
- UX Design – 40 hrs
- Testing and QA – 50 hrs

Since the 305-hour Bottom-Up estimate falls within the 144-414 hour range from the previous two estimates, and it is tied in to planned work packages, we selected 305 hours as the planning estimate.

ROI Analysis

Total Investment & Financial Baseline

To evaluate the financial viability for the SkillUp User Portfolio Management Slice, we added all development expenses, contingency reserves, and management reserves form the project budget:

- Base Build Estimate (Labor + Non-Labor): \$28,836
- Cost Baseline (With the Contingency Reserve): \$31.286
- Total Budget Request (Total Investment Cost): \$32,850 (this includes the 5% management reserve)
- Annual Operating Cost (Post-Launch Support & Hosting): \$35,760 / year

Projected Returns

Even though the main purpose of SkillUp is to solve user motivation and progress-tracking challenges, the platform will generate monetary value with external partnerships and monetization features:

- Instructor & Course Commissions: Revenue splits from third-party instructors offering specialized courses, training content, and certifications through the platform.
- Sponsored Content & Promotions: Paid Promotional placements for organizations, equipment manufacturers, and outside contributors targeting active recreational users.
- Data Monetization: Selling trend data and hobbyist analytics to equipment manufacturers, event organizers, and marker researchers looking to understand recreational trends among the expected launch base of 1,000 to 2,000 active users.